



Hot Planet

Around the world, in a single week in July, multiple regions were the hottest they have ever been. <https://dgit.in/Aug18-29-1>



Flying spiders

Ballooning spiders travel thousands of km across the planet by using the electric field of the Earth. <https://dgit.in/Aug18-29-2>

certain system services do need to be running in the background when your phone is switched on. However, you should be fine with killing off third-party applications. This section gives you visualisation of the amount of memory occupied by the system and third-party apps.

NETWORK ACTIVITY

As stated earlier, you can't be sure which apps are trying to connect to the internet even though they don't really need a connection. GlassWire Data Usage Monitor keeps a track of all the applications that try to establish an internet connection through cellular or Wi-Fi. It conveniently sends you an alert whenever an app connects to the internet for the first time. Not just connections, you can also track the amount of data uploaded and downloaded by every app. It serves as a great tool to keep in check which apps are using a lot of data. You will be able to view the amount of data being downloaded or uploaded by every app and accordingly change your preferences. If you've wondered where your monthly cellular data vanishes, this is a great app to help you save unnecessary usage of your valuable data.

Download: <https://dgit.in/GlsswrAnd>

BATTERY LEVELS

Some applications running in the background take too much battery. You can easily determine the same if the app is also taking up too much RAM. For a better visualisation of which apps are responsible for your



phone running out of battery, you can take advantage of the built-in system battery application. Under Settings, you can find the app that gives you all sorts of data such as your battery level, time since the last full charge and screen usage since the same full charge. Apart from that, it will also list down the applications or services that used up the battery since a full charge and tell you how much of the battery they utilised. If you find a certain application using too much battery, you could replace or stop using it completely. If you wish to see a detailed breakdown of your battery stats such as discharging speed (down to individual

apps), battery health, etc., then you should definitely check out AccuBattery. It also gives you data on the charging speed and average battery usage over a few days.

Download: <https://dgit.in/AccBttry>

SENSOR DATA

Your smartphone comes loaded with sensors to record different kinds of data that is ultimately used by different applications. System information apps will only confirm which sensors are present inside. However, there are a few apps that will visualise all the data being recorded by the sensors. There are two apps we came across for both beginner and advanced users. Android Sensors (formerly called SensorLab) displays all the sensory data using graphs and charts in one single screen. You can individually expand

the graphs to fullscreen and even record the sensory activity from the app. However, it doesn't visualise data from all the sensors. A more advanced form of tracking and recording data from your sensors would be by Physics Toolbox Suite. This app is a gold mine if you're a

physics nerd because it generates so much data from your sensors. Some of the interesting ones are Colour Detector that can give you the colour of a subject in hex code. You can also emulate a Spectrogram for audio and even generate tones at different frequencies. The best part about this app is you can record and save the data and then export the values in a .csv format. This app could be overwhelming for beginners but it's an interesting way to learn about the kind of data a phone's sensors can generate.

Download: Android Sensors - <https://dgit.in/AndSens>
Physics Toolbox Suite - <https://dgit.in/PhyTool>

BONUS: SYSTEM INFORMATION

If you've always wanted to read a detailed description of all the fea-

tures present on your phone, we would recommend Device Info: Hardware and Software. To refer to the specifications of your phone, you would be dependent on the product page or websites which list them down. If you fall among the sceptical ones, a more trustworthy approach would be using system info apps. There are many out there but the free ones usually have a clunky user-interface overwhelmed with ads. This one lists down details of different components like Processor, Network, Camera, Display, Storage, etc. The app is simple to use with a colourful user-interface.

Download: <https://dgit.in/DeviceInf>

